

RELEASE ENGINEERING · PLATFORM

Deployment strategies

Rolling · Blue-green · Canary

PRESENTER · TEAM

The strategy is not a matter of taste. It is decided by how fast you must be able to roll back, and by whether your traffic can be split.

01

ROLLING

02

BLUE-GREEN

03

CANARY

Three ways to replace a running version

02

	01 ROLLING	02 BLUE-GREEN	03 CANARY
HOW IT RELEASES	Replacing instances in batches	Switching a router to a second full stack	Sending a slice of traffic to the new build
HOW IT ROLLS BACK	Deploying the old build again, batch by batch	Switching the router back	Withdrawing the slice
WHAT IT COSTS YOU	One fleet, with headroom for the surge	Two full environments at once	Request routing and per-slice telemetry

Only one of the three undoes a release by deploying again. The other two undo it by routing.

The two questions that actually decide it

03

TRAFFIC CANNOT BE SPLIT BY REQUEST

TRAFFIC CAN BE SPLIT BY REQUEST

A BAD RELEASE MUST
STOP AT ONCE

Blue-green

Stopping at once needs a switch. A switch does not need per-request routing.

Canary

Both answers demanded. Exposure is bought a slice at a time, and withdrawn the same way.

A BAD RELEASE CAN
WAIT FOR A REDEPLOY

Rolling

If a redeploy is a fast enough exit, one fleet does it and nothing else is needed.

Rolling, still

Splitting traffic buys staged exposure, not a faster exit. It does not decide this alone.

Amber marks the most demanding cell here, not the best strategy.

What each strategy demands before it works

04

01

HEALTH CHECKS

A check that only proves the process is listening will pass a broken release — and all three strategies promote on that signal.

**A BAD BATCH IS
PROMOTED**

02

ROLLBACK

A rollback path that has never been run is a plan, not a capability. The strategies differ only in how fast a working one fires.

**THE EXIT IS
UNTESTED**

03

SESSIONS

All three serve two versions at once, if only for a moment. State pinned to one instance dies with that instance.

**USERS LOSE THEIR
STATE**

Missing one of these leaves you with the slowest exit you own.

Two answers pick the strategy: how long a bad release may keep serving, and whether traffic can be split.

PRESENTER · TEAM

01

THE EXIT BUDGET

How long may a bad release serve before we call it an incident?

02

THE ROUTER

Can our ingress split traffic by request today? If not, what would it take?

03

THE DRILL

When did we last roll back on purpose, and what did it cost us to find out?